01

UMĀSVĀTI / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The Tattvārthasūtra or Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra of Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The Tattvārthasūtra or Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra of Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.**

02

THEORY OF REALITY □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

ANSWER LINE: **Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).**

03

1 Anekāntavāda as metaphysical thesis

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Anekāntavāda is not mere indecision.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.**

04

2 Dravya as sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The real (sat) is what possesses utpāda (origination), vyaya (decay), and dhrauvya (persistence or permanence) together.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The real (sat) is what possesses utpāda (origination), vyaya (decay), and dhrauvya (persistence or permanence) together.**

05

3 Six dravyas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. □ Kāla (time) is a real dravya in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is not an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of pañcāstikāya plus kāla.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism classically recognizes six dravyas: jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, and kāla.**

06

4 Guṇa and paryāya □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Every dravya possesses guṇa (essential qualities) and paryāya (modes or modifications).**

07

5 Jīva and ajīva □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The most fundamental ontological distinction is between jīva (conscious) and ajīva (non-conscious).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The most fundamental ontological distinction is between jīva (conscious) and ajīva (non-conscious).**

08

6 Nature of jīva □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore jīva is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.**

09

7 Pudgala □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Pudgala is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing rūpa (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Pudgala is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing rūpa (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.**

10

1 Primary division: pratyakṣa and parokṣa □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jaina epistemology distinguishes pratyakṣa (direct knowledge) and parokṣa (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word pratyakṣa in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.**

11

2 Five kinds of jñāna □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

1. □ Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of jñāna (knowledge): mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyaya, and kevala.**

12

3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna under mithyā-darśana □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

4. □ The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under mithyā-darśana (false vision or wrong orientation).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

1. □ Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism recognizes mati-ajñāna or kumati, śruta-ajñāna or kuśruta, and vibhaṅga-jñāna as wrong cognition.**

13

4 Later Jaina logic and indirect pramāṇas □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. □ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, and Yaśovijaya are important names for the developed Jaina pramāṇa tradition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

3. □ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism admits anumāna (inference) and śabda (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.**

14

5 Critical link: pramāṇa → nayavāda → syādvāda □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Ordinary human cognition is kṣāyopaśamika (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and it is therefore necessarily partial.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Ordinary human cognition is kṣāyopaśamika (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and it is therefore necessarily partial.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.**

15

SAPTABHAṄGĪNAYA □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

ANSWER LINE: **Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.**

16

1 Nayavāda: standpoint-theory

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Nayavāda teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a naya, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.**

17

2 The seven nayas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Classical Jainism enumerates seven nayas, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Reply. □□ They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Classical Jainism enumerates seven nayas, each marking a characteristic standpoint.**

18

3 Syādvāda as logical expression

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."**

19

4 Saptabhaṅgī: the seven predications, exactly and in order □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. syād nāsti — in some respect, it is not.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

6. syād nāsti ca avaktavyaṃ — in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.**

20

5 Blind men and the elephant □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument. □□ The illustration dramatizes the difference between partial correctness and exclusive completeness.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of anekāntavāda: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.**

21

6 Five kinds of knowledge □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument. □ The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of five kinds of knowledge: mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyaya, and kevala.**

22

7 Standard objection: is anekāntavāda self-refuting or trivial? □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting—because the claim that "all reality is many-sided" is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting—because the claim that "all reality is many-sided" is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

If qualified, it may lose universal force.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting—because the claim that "all reality is many-sided" is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.**

23

8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.**

24

9 Is Jainism pluralistic and realistic? (2025) □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □□ Yes, Jainism is strongly pluralistic and broadly realistic, though both labels require nuance.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Nuance. □□ Its realism is qualified realism, because judgement is standpoint-indexed.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □□ Yes, Jainism is strongly pluralistic and broadly realistic, though both labels require nuance.**

25

BONDAGE AND LIBERATION □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

ANSWER LINE: **Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).**

26

1 Karma as subtle material substance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that karma is a subtle material substance, a form of pudgala that flows toward and binds the soul.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

This obscuration requires a real binding factor.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

That factor is karma, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that karma is a subtle material substance, a form of pudgala that flows toward and binds the soul.**

27

2 The fivefold soteriological sequence □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Austerity and purification burn off old karma.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Saṃvara and nirjarā are not the same: one stops new karma; the other removes old karma.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.**

28

3 Bhāvabandha and dravyabandha (2024) □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

This inner deformation is bhāvabandha.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Objection (analytical objection). □ Why not collapse them into one process?

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Bondage has two closely related forms: bhāvabandha (psychic bondage) and dravyabandha (material bondage).**

29

4 The three jewels □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Liberation requires the three jewels (ratnatraya): samyag-darśana (right faith/vision), samyag-jñāna (right knowledge), and samyag-cāritra (right conduct).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

One must live in accordance with that insight.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Liberation requires the three jewels (ratnatraya): samyag-darśana (right faith/vision), samyag-jñāna (right knowledge), and samyag-cāritra (right conduct).**

30

5 Five mahāvratas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, and aparigraha.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, and aparigraha.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Argument. □ These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, and aparigraha.**

31

6 Kevala-jñāna □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Kevala-jñāna is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Kevala-jñāna is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.**

32

7 Mokṣa □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Mokṣa is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to siddha-śilā.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Mokṣa is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to siddha-śilā.**

33

1 Seven tattvas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

6. □ Mokṣa names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Example. □ A person's anger is not merely a mental event; it opens āsrava, deepens bandha, and must be countered by saṃvara and nirjarā.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Āsrava explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Metaphysics is organized around soteriology; the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, and mokṣa.**

34

2 Nine padārthas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Distinction. □ Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for mokṣa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □□ They can also be subsumed under āsrava and bandha because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Example. □ Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).**

35

3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul's ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. □ Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul's ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul's ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.**

36

1 Karma is material pudgala □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: karma-pudgala is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

4. □ Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: karma-pudgala is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.**

37

2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. □ Mohanīya is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātīyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātīyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul's essential nature.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The eight karmas divide into ghātīyā karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and aghātīyā karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.**

38

3 Four parameters of bandha □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).**

39

1 Ordered list □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Stage 4 is decisive because samyag-darśana first becomes stable enough to orient the path.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Stage 4 is decisive because samyag-darśana first becomes stable enough to orient the path.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Stage 4 is decisive because samyag-darśana first becomes stable enough to orient the path.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.**

40

2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jaina doctrine distinguishes upaśama-śreṇi (ladder of suppression) and kṣapaka-śreṇi (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Jaina doctrine distinguishes upaśama-śreṇi (ladder of suppression) and kṣapaka-śreṇi (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.**

41

SALLEKHANĀ / SANTHĀRĀ: DEATH WITHOUT PASSION □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Distinction. □ Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.**

42

INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

ANSWER LINE: **Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.**

43

NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

ANSWER LINE: **The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.**

44

1 Śaṃkara's critique of anekāntavāda □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no," practical action loses clear guidance.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.**

45

2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

1. □ A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.**

46

3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Jaina reply. □ Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.**

47

4 Nyāya critique of the soul's expansion and material karma □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ If the self has parts or pradeśas, its eternality seems threatened.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

1. □ An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.**

48

5 Sāṃkhya/Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

3. □ If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.**

49

6 Cārvāka / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument of the critic. □ Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Argument of the critic. □ Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

ANSWER LINE: **Statement. □ A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.**

50

COMMON UPSC TRAPS □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala). □ Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta. □ Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātīyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Six dravyas, but only five astikāyas. □ Kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the dravya list has six.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala). □ Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.

ANSWER LINE: **Anekāntavāda ≠ syādvāda ≠ saptabhaṅgī. □ Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.**

51

KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Anekāntavāda — doctrine of many-sided reality. □

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Exam sentence: "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." □□

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Dravya–guṇa–paryāya — substance, qualities, modes. □

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Exam sentence: "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." □□

ANSWER LINE: **Anekāntavāda — doctrine of many-sided reality. □**

52

Bound and liberated soul

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Distinction: the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Distinction: the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.**

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CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ Priority: Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Required doctrinal depth: The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and karma's direct bearing on liberation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Trap / answer consequence: Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Trap / answer consequence: Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

ANSWER LINE: **□□ Priority: Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.**

54

INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

ANSWER LINE: **Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.**

55

CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

ANSWER LINE: **Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.**

56

GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. □ Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. □ Its ahiṃsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

ANSWER LINE: **1. □ Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.**